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US, Iran sign tentative deal for truce

Agreement to extend ceasefire takes effect at ceremony Friday

By Jon Gambrell,
Elena Becatoros
and Michelle L. Price
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI, United Arab Emirates — An initial agreement between the United States and Iran to extend their shaky ceasefire inched toward a formal signing despite questions Monday over the fate of Tehran's

nuclear program and an offensive by Israel in Lebanon that could prolong the fighting and scuttle the deal.

The agreement signed electronically Sunday is meant to provide a meaningful truce in a monthslong war that has killed thousands across the Middle East, including the top leaders of Iran's theocracy, and raised the prices of fuel, food and other basic goods far beyond the region. But logistical and military challenges underscored the fragile nature of the deal, which was set for a ceremonial signing Friday in

Geneva.

At the core of the pact is a planned reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, a crucial waterway whose blockage has choked the supply of the world's oil and natural gas. Yet even a full reopening would not immediately alleviate the global energy crisis its closure created.

Another potential obstacle concerns Israel, which joined the U.S. in launching the war on Feb. 28, but it is not party to the deal. The Israeli military launched airstrikes Sunday in southern Lebanon, where it is fighting the Iranian-backed

Hezbollah militant group, and the Israeli defense minister said Monday that the country would not withdraw from land seized in Lebanon, where Israel is fighting the Iranian-backed Hezbollah militant group.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu on Monday said the agreement between the U.S. and Iran was Trump's decision. Netanyahu said Israel has its own interests, primarily protecting against a potential nuclear threat from Iran. He said Iran wanted Israel to withdraw from Lebanon,

but he stood firm, saying Israel would remain in the buffer zone "as long as necessary."

"I tell you, citizens of Israel, the struggle is not over. We will need to continue to be vigilant, to remain strong and determined, to defend ourselves as necessary," he said.

The agreement also faces other major challenges. It gives just 60 days to decide what to do about Iran's stockpile of highly enriched uranium and its nuclear program — which the U.S. and Israel worry

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College programs help bridge divides

Dialogue used as a tool for students to address ideological differences

By Kate Perez
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Isabela Torres Reyes often finds herself waiting thoughtfully before she speaks — something she didn't always do six months ago. At the start of the school year, the recent DePaul University graduate was so eager to share her thoughts that she sometimes jumped into conversations early. Now, after completing a 10-week dialogue course, she's leaving college with a better sense of how to listen and respond to people to create meaningful conversations.

Torres Reyes gained that understanding through DePaul's Bridge-building Fellowship, which aims to help students develop dialogue skills across different ideologies. Being in the program helped her understand how background and experiences shape people's views. She found herself asking, "What do you care about that I'm not seeing?" instead of focusing on a person's differing opinion, she said.

Beyond that, there aren't enough chances for people to think and respond during conversations before being cut off "because you want to say what you want to say," Torres Reyes said. "We just all find it really difficult to open up, and so any opportunity to learn how to do so, to practice doing so, I think is important, especially living in our bubble of college," she said.

Programs designed to use dialogue to bridge division among college students are increasingly

See **PROGRAMS** on Page A2



The Obama Presidential Center prepares for opening on June 3 in Chicago's Jackson Park.

BRIAN CASSELLA/TRIBUNE

Planning to visit the Obama center?

President Barack Obama and wife Michelle will be on hand to open the facility in Thursday ceremony. See our guide for making your own visit. **Chicagoland**, Page 3

Bulls hire Splitter as next head coach

Former Portland Trail Blazers interim coach Tiago Splitter brought on to helm the Bulls as the team enters a transitional period. **Chicago Sports**



An American linden tree dating to the 1850s sits destroyed on Monday, across Eighth Street from President Abraham Lincoln's house, left, in Springfield. The "witness tree," growing in front of the Dean House, is believed to be the last one remaining that Lincoln would have seen on the block before leaving for the presidency in 1861. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Storm topples the last Lincoln 'witness tree'

It was planted in 1850s by Springfield neighbors of the future president

By Paul Eisenberg
DAILY SOUTHTOWN

There was no indication that the American linden across the street from Abraham Lincoln's home in Springfield was any different than any of the other 270 trees that populate the four-block National Historic Site along Eighth Street.

On Friday, a cloud of irritated bees swarmed the linden's trunk about 20 feet up, where wind from strong storms the night before had snapped it. Yellow caution tape

surrounded the former treetop, now resting in the street and front yard of the Dean House, named for the mother and son who planted the linden tree in the 1850s when they were Lincoln's neighbors.

As visitors skirted the dying tree, few realized they were seeing the remains of history. The linden was what park officials termed a "witness tree" — one that was alive when Lincoln lived in the home across the street, one he could gaze out upon from the front windows and porch of his home.

"When Lincoln came out his

front door, it would be one of the first things he saw," said John Popolis, museum technician at the National Park Service site.

The tree was the last one in the park that officials had positively identified as being there at the same time as the future president. It was the last remaining of four lindens planted by the Deans in the 1850s. A ring count on a cross section of one of the four that was cut down in 1993 dated them to 1856 or '57, according to Susan Haake, curator and acting chief of interpretation at the Lincoln

Home site.

Nobody was on site about 7:30 or 8 p.m. Thursday night when the witness tree came down. The city had shut down as the city endured a second day of severe weather that brought nine confirmed tornadoes to central Illinois June 10 and 11, according to the National Weather Service.

Haake said the toppled tree was discovered early Friday morning by a maintenance worker.

"It's a sad day for everyone

See **TREE** on Page A4

State tries to close Evanston psychiatric facility

Albany Care has seen string of reported crimes and violations

By Robert McCoppin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

After struggling with a history of mental illness, including schizophrenia and bipolar disorder, a 44-year-old woman was admitted to Albany Care psychiatric facility in Evanston in 2023 for her own health and safety.

However, in October of that year, the woman was left alone and unsupervised when a man who also lived at the facility entered her room and raped her, according to a lawsuit filed

last year in Cook County on the woman's behalf, charging negligence by Albany Care. The woman was taken to a hospital where, the suit stated, testing confirmed that she had been sexually assaulted. The suspect was charged with home invasion and aggravated criminal sexual assault.

While the allegations are horrific, the incident was far from isolated. It was among 657 calls to 911 involving Albany Care residents from 2020 to May of 2025, according to the city of Evanston. Those included reports of a man with a gun, three drug overdoses, 56 disorderly conducts, 11 batteries, 13 trespasses and five robber-



Mark Williams wipes sweat from his face as he stands in his room and speaks about his experience at Albany Care on June 5 in Evanston.

STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

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